Project proposal

Title

WUA Student Support and Service Request System (SSRS)

Problem statement

Routine university service requests can involve several parties: a student raises an issue, a service unit receives it, a staff member investigates it, and the student needs to know whether it has been resolved. If the process relies on disconnected messages or informal follow-ups, requests may be difficult to trace and staff may lack a shared view of their status. This is a problem hypothesis, not a confirmed claim about WUA. Short interviews with students and service staff will be used to establish whether the problem exists locally and which request types are most affected.

Aim and objectives

Aim:

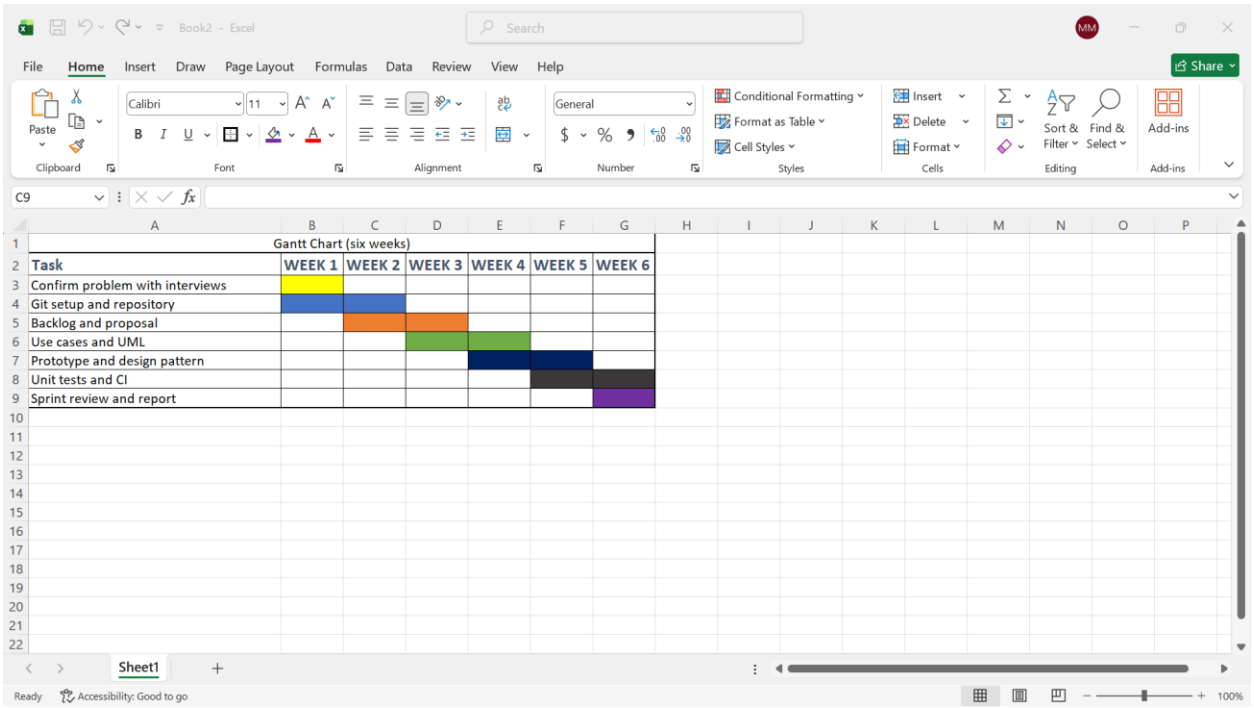
1. Design and prototype a secure, traceable digital system for routine student service requests.
2. Provide a structured form for submitting a request and generating a unique reference number.
3. Allow students to view the status and history of their own requests.
4. Allow authorized staff to assign, update, and close requests.
5. Protect student information through role-based access and minimal data collection.
6. Use automated tests and a continuous integration workflow to detect regressions.

Scope and key features

In scope: authentication prototype, request submission, request listing, status updates, category selection, timestamps, and basic workload counts. Out of scope for the first release: emergency response, payments, medical records, confidential counselling case management, and production integration with university systems.

Gantt plan (six weeks)

Task	W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6
Confirm problem with interviews	●					
Git setup and repository	●	●				
Backlog and proposal		●	●			
Use cases and UML			●	●		
Prototype and design pattern				●	●	
Unit tests and CI					●	●
Sprint review and report						●



Risk register

Risk	Likelihood / impact	Mitigation
The problem hypothesis is not confirmed.	Medium / High	Conduct short interviews first; adjust the project based on evidence.
Unauthorized users view another student's requests.	Medium / High	Enforce server-side ownership checks and role permissions; test access-control cases.
Scope grows beyond available time.	High / Medium	Deliver Must-have features first; defer Could-have items.
Internet or device access is unreliable.	Medium / Medium	Keep the prototype lightweight and test on mobile-sized screens; document local setup.
Loss of code or accidental secret exposure.	Medium / High	Push regularly to GitHub; use .gitignore; never commit credentials or real personal data.